

Responsible drinking

Practicing responsible drinking helps teens and adults to stay safe.

Keep an eye on how much you drink and know what your limit is.

If you're going out with friends, help each other to stay safe.

Eat beforehand. Having a full stomach delays how quickly alcohol is absorbed into the bloodstream.

Drink soft drinks or water between alcoholic drinks.

Never accept drinks from strangers. They may have "spiked" your drink by adding drugs or a shot to it.

Never drink and drive. Alcohol impairs a person's coordination and judgment.

Make sure you watch your drink at all times, in case someone tampers with it.

Say no if you feel you've had enough. Everyone has different limits, so don't try to keep up with friends.

PARENT TIPS

Encouraging responsible drinking

- Don't make alcohol an off-limit conversation topic. Aim to talk about alcohol openly with your teen, preferably before they start drinking. Equally, if there's any history of alcohol dependency in the family, share that information honestly.
- Banning your teen from drinking alcohol may make it more appealing. Instead, it may be better to recognize that your teen might want to drink, but encourage them to do so sensibly.
- Lead by example and drink responsibly yourself.

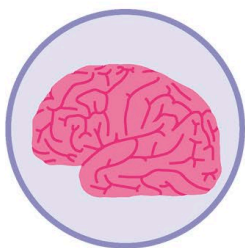


△ Peer pressure

Make sure your teen knows it's okay to say "no" to another drink if they feel they've had enough.

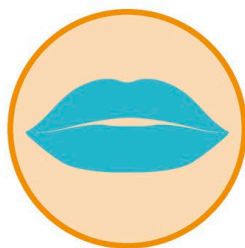
Long-term effects of drinking excessively

Regularly drinking alcohol in large quantities can have a long-term, negative impact on a person's mental and physical health, so it's important to drink in moderation.



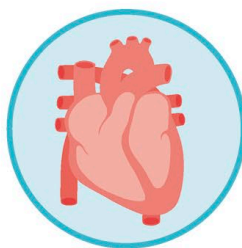
△ Brain

Alcohol can cause anxiety, depression, low mood, and sleeplessness.



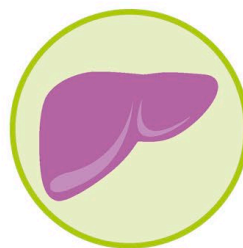
△ Mouth

The effects of alcohol range from bad breath to mouth cancer.



△ Heart

Alcohol increases blood pressure, heart rate, and the risk of having a stroke.



△ Liver

Heavy drinkers are susceptible to liver damage.



△ Stomach

Regularly drinking large amounts can cause diarrhea and heartburn.